

Detection report — grey squirrel (*Sciurus carolinensis*)

Window: 2026-06-28 to 2026-07-16 (local dates, Europe/London)

Alert events: 7

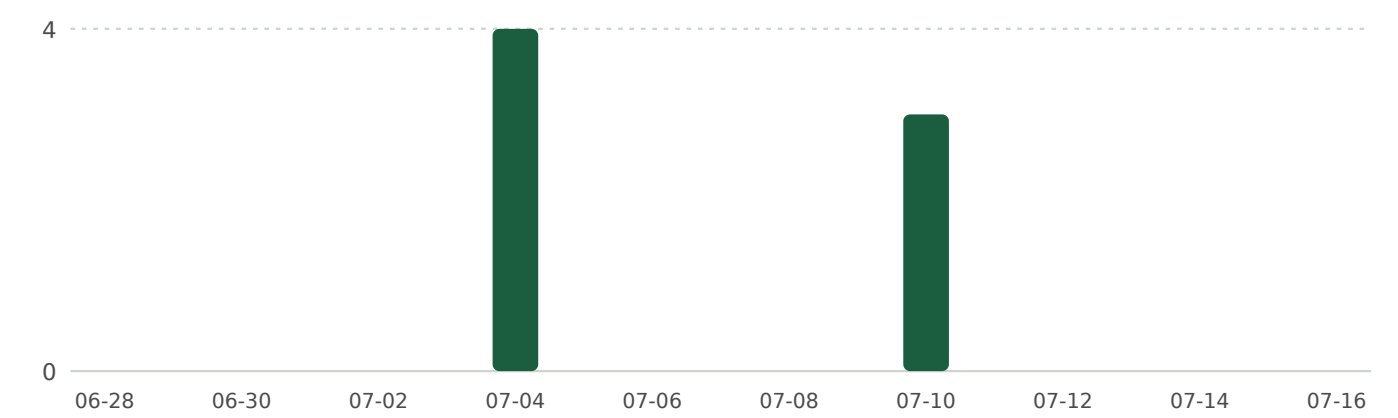
Summary

During the window from June 28th to July 16th, 2026, there were a total of 7 alert events related to grey squirrels. These events were most frequent on the 4th and 10th of July, with 4 and 3 alert events respectively. There were no alert events recorded on the 5th, 6th, 7th, 8th, or 9th of July. The overall trend across the window was roughly steady, with no significant increase or decrease in activity.

What this supports: limited evidence of occasional *Sciurus carolinensis* activity at a single feeder-facing camera — recorded on 2 of 19 days with data (2026-07-04 to 2026-07-10), busiest 4–10 Jul 2026.

Day-by-day alert-event counts

The 7 dated event(s); this table sums to 7. Counts are alert events, not animals — see honesty notes below.



The bars are the SAME per-day counts as the table below — discrete daily alert-event counts, not a trend line. No values are derived, smoothed, or interpolated; every bar equals its table row.

Date (local dates, Europe/London)	Alert events
2026-06-28	0
2026-06-29	0
2026-06-30	0
2026-07-01	0
2026-07-02	0
2026-07-03	0
2026-07-04	4
2026-07-05	0
2026-07-06	0
2026-07-07	0
2026-07-08	0
2026-07-09	0
2026-07-10	3

Date (local dates, Europe/London)	Alert events
2026-07-11	0
2026-07-12	0
2026-07-13	0
2026-07-14	0
2026-07-15	0
2026-07-16	0
Total (dated)	7

Monitoring effort

The requested window spans **456h**. Of that, the dataset's coverage — from the first to the last detection delivered (2026-06-28 09:24 → 2026-07-16 12:15 UTC), a span of **434.9h** (not the calendar range those dates touch) — carries the data; the remaining **21h** fall outside it, before the first or after the last detection, where monitoring status is **unknown**, not zero activity.

Within that span, proven system downtime accounts for **0.0h**, so the system was **confirmed operational for 434.9 of 434.9 hours (100%)**.

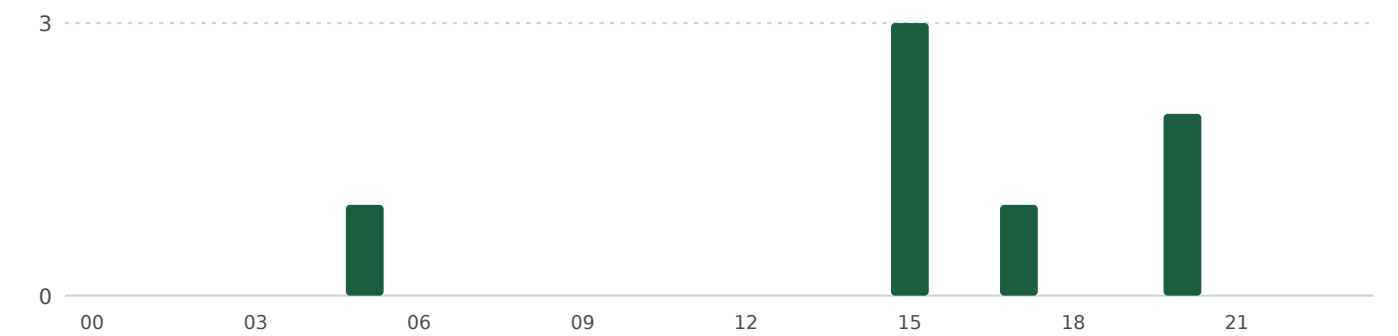
*The daily counts above are **raw over this effort** — deliberately NOT divided by operational hours. With one camera, one location, and no control for time-of-day, an events-per-hour rate would not be a sound figure; the uptime is given so the counts can be read against the effort behind them, not turned into a rate here.*

How these events were dated

7 event(s) had no decodable capture time and are placed by alert send time instead, flagged in the data rather than dropped.

Time-of-day distribution

Dated alert events by hour of capture, local time (Europe/London). N = 7. Events, not animals.



Detections concentrate in the 05:00–20:59 window, peaking at 15:00, with none overnight — consistent with a diurnal species and daytime-only capture.

Hours (local)	Alert events
00:00–02:59	0
03:00–05:59	1
06:00–08:59	0
09:00–11:59	0
12:00–14:59	0

Hours (local)	Alert events
15:00-17:59	4
18:00-20:59	2
21:00-23:59	0
Total	7

This is detection TIMING under whatever the camera's trigger/schedule was — not a behavioural rate, and still uncorrected for effort-by-hour (the system was not equally up every hour). Events, not animals.

Period-over-period comparison

No comparable prior period exists in the data — the previous equal-length period (**9-27 Jun 2026**) is entirely before the earliest dated grey squirrel record held (2026-07-04), so no change can be computed. (This window: **28 Jun-16 Jul 2026**, 7 dated alert events.)

*Compared on **dated** alert events only. This window's figure (**7**) is the day-by-day table's dated total; the prior figure (**0**) is the same measure over the previous period. Undated events (no usable timestamp) and unmapped detections are excluded from BOTH — they cannot be placed in a period — and are disclosed separately.*

Notable observations

Computed from the stored detection records — no model involvement. Same basis as the table above: alert events (not animals), local dates, Europe/London, capture time where it was decoded.

Busiest day: 4 Jul 2026 — 4 alert events.

Quietest active day: 10 Jul 2026 — 3 alert events.

Days with no grey squirrel alert events: 17 of 19 in the window — but they do not all mean the same thing: - **16 with the system confirmed delivering** (other species arrived that day) and no grey squirrel detected — only these support 'none seen that day'. - **1 undetermined** — no proven outage, but nothing of ANY species arrived either, so a real absence and undetected downtime cannot be told apart.

Non-target activity: 468 alert events from 3 other species in the same window. - **Columba palumbus** — 458 alert events on 28 Jun, 29 Jun, 30 Jun, 1 Jul, 2 Jul, 3 Jul 2026 (+12 more day(s)) - **Corvus corone** — 8 alert events on 29 Jun, 30 Jun, 3 Jul, 4 Jul 2026 - **Felis catus** — 2 alert events on 4 Jul 2026

System downtime: none detected — no delivery silence in this window was followed by back-dated captures, which is the only evidence that distinguishes an outage from a genuinely quiet period.

grey squirrel absent — system confirmed operational: these are real absences, not missing data. The camera was delivering other species throughout each period below. - No grey squirrel detected 28 Jun 09:24 → 04 Jul 14:39 UTC (149.3h) while 274 alert events of other species arrived — the system was demonstrably working. - No grey squirrel detected 10 Jul 19:13 → 16 Jul 12:15 UTC (137.0h) while 79 alert events of other species arrived — the system was demonstrably working. - No grey squirrel detected 04 Jul 16:43 → 10 Jul 04:50 UTC (132.1h) while 95 alert events of other species arrived — the system was demonstrably working.

Cross-check agreement is reported under 'Data-quality flags' below, where the per-detection rationales live.

Unverified model descriptions (not observations)

None available for these events. The computed highlights above are unaffected.

Data-quality flags

The cross-check did not corroborate 7 of 7 detections (100%) — BioCLIP's own top-1 identification was not the upstream species. The verdict is species-level: a near miss in the same genus is still a disagreement, so the distance below is what says how serious each one is. - **different class of animal (5, 71% of disagreements)** - 2026-07-04: upstream 'SciurusCarolinensis' -> Sciurus carolinensis, but BioCLIP's top-1 'Branta canadensis' is a different taxon (other_animal) - 2026-07-04: upstream 'SciurusCarolinensis' -> Sciurus carolinensis, but BioCLIP's top-1 'Poecile atricapillus' is a different taxon (other_animal) - **BioCLIP read a plant, fungus or other non-animal (2, 29% of disagreements)** - 2026-07-04: upstream 'SciurusCarolinensis' -> Sciurus carolinensis, but BioCLIP's top-1 'Eremophila weldii' is a different taxon (non_animal) - 2026-07-04: upstream 'SciurusCarolinensis' -> Sciurus carolinensis, but BioCLIP's top-1 'Poa pratensis' is a different taxon (non_animal) **Enrichment not run (VLM on 7 event(s))**: ingested without enrichment (e.g. via store), not a model failure.

What these figures mean

- Each of the **7 alert events** here is an alert-event count, not an animal — one alert event is one (alert rule x image) match at best-per-label; two animals in one frame register as a single event, and other species in frame, sub-threshold detections, and repeat visits are not represented (Decision 4). So this is 7 events, not 7 animals.
- Each of the **7 dated events** in the table above is placed by CAMERA CAPTURE TIME, decoded from the image filename and converted from Europe/London local time to UTC (Decision 3, amended: capture time is the preferred temporal key where available; alert send time is still stored, never overwritten). Capture time was validated against the timestamp burned into the image pixels. Where no capture time could be decoded the alert send time is used instead and the row is flagged. Send time is a poor proxy for capture time — usually close, but delivery is not guaranteed: an outage or backlog flushes a queue of older captures under one send timestamp, mis-dating events by whole days through delivery latency rather than midnight-boundary rounding. Note that the Europe/London -> UTC conversion uses real DST rules (zoneinfo), not a fixed offset, but it is VALIDATED ONLY WITHIN BST: the evaluated dataset (2026-06-28..2026-07-16) predates the October DST change, so autumn/winter (GMT) captures, and local times that are ambiguous or non-existent across a DST transition, remain unvalidated and are flagged per row.
- Every event here (**7 events** in total) was ingested by a parser whose NOMINAL alert format was validated field-for-field against a real captured alert email on 2026-07-16 (Decision 7); edge-case variants (zero or missing attachments, malformed body, test emails) remain validated against the reconstruction only.
- This report found **no prior equal-length period with data** to weigh the window against; a period-over-period change is the difference between two alert-event counts for the two dated windows named above — not evidence of a trend, a seasonal pattern, or a change in animal abundance; with the little history held here it describes only those two specific windows (Change 2). The earliest dated record held for this class is 2026-07-04.